

Paknam Slices

VEGETARIAN · NO ONION · NO GARLIC · NO ALLIUM · NO ALUMINIUM

SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	25 min	45 min

Cookware: Stainless steel steamer and steel thali - never aluminium

Steamed gram-and-herb cake, sliced like a savoury terrine. No fermented fish, no onion, no garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
150	g	besan (gram flour)
120	ml	water
20	g	fresh ginger, grated
2	pieces	green chilli, finely chopped
30	g	fresh coriander leaves, chopped
1	tsp	salt
1/2	tsp	hing (asafoetida)
1	tbsp	mustard oil
1	pieces	banana leaf, to line the steamer

METHOD

1. Mix besan, water, ginger, chilli, coriander, salt, hing and mustard oil to a thick cake batter.
2. Line a steel steamer thali with the banana leaf. Pour in the batter 2 cm thick.
3. Steam 20 minutes. Cool 5 minutes, turn out and slice into 8 fingers. Serve warm.

Kanghou Mixed Veg

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	12 min	22 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

High-heat dry-fried seasonal vegetables. Ginger and chilli stand in for alliums.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
150	g	cabbage, shredded
100	g	french beans, cut 3 cm
100	g	carrot, batons
20	g	fresh ginger, julienne
2	pieces	green chilli, slit
2	tblsp	mustard oil
1	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Heat mustard oil in a steel kadhai until it just smokes, then lower the flame.
2. Add ginger and chilli, then cabbage, beans and carrot. Stir-fry 8-10 minutes.
3. Season with salt. Vegetables should stay bright, not soggy. Serve at once.

Kangsoi Cup

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	15 min	25 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

A small bowl of clear vegetable soup to open the meal.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
100	g	cabbage, cubed
100	g	potato, cubed
80	g	french beans, cut
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
2	pieces	green chilli, slit
700	ml	water
1	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Bring water, ginger and chilli to a boil in a stainless steel pot.
2. Add cabbage, potato, beans and salt. Simmer 12 minutes until just tender.
3. Ladle into steel cups. Broth should be light and peppery, never cloudy from stock cubes.

Chamthong Stew

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	25 min	40 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Clear Manipuri vegetable stew - the home pot. No nga-ri, no onion, no garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
150	g	cabbage, large cubes
150	g	potato, large cubes
100	g	carrot, chunks
100	g	french beans, cut 4 cm
80	g	pumpkin, cubes
25	g	fresh ginger, crushed
2	pieces	green chilli, slit
15	g	fresh coriander leaves
1	tsp	salt
1	L	water

METHOD

1. Put water, ginger and chilli in a stainless steel pot and bring to a rolling boil.
2. Add potato and pumpkin first; cook 8 minutes. Add cabbage, carrot and beans.
3. Season with salt. Simmer until all vegetables are tender but hold their shape, about 12 minutes more.
4. Finish with coriander. Serve in steel bowls with sticky rice. Never aluminium.

Ooti

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SERVES

4

PREP

15 min

COOK

35 min

TOTAL

50 min

Cookware: Stainless steel or clay pot - never aluminium

Creamy yellow-pea stew of Manipur. A pinch of soda is traditional; skip onion and garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	yellow peas (vatana), soaked 6 hours
800	ml	water
25	g	fresh ginger, crushed
2	pieces	green chilli, slit
1/4	tsp	baking soda
1	tsp	salt
2	tbsp	cooked rice, to thicken (optional)
1	tbsp	mustard oil

METHOD

1. Drain the peas. Cook with water, ginger, chilli and soda in a clay or steel pot until very soft, 30 minutes.
2. Mash a ladle of peas against the pot. Stir in optional rice. Season with salt.
3. Finish with mustard oil. The stew should be creamy, not watery. Serve with sticky rice.

Veg Kangsoi

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	25 min	40 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Vegetable kangsoi without fermented fish. Lemon and chilli give the snap.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
250	g	mixed seasonal vegetables, cut
100	g	seasonal greens, chopped
25	g	fresh ginger, crushed
3	pieces	green chilli, slit
800	ml	water
1	tsp	salt
1	tbsp	lemon juice

METHOD

1. Boil water with ginger and chilli. Add mixed vegetables and salt; simmer 15 minutes.
2. Stir in greens for the last 4 minutes.
3. Off the heat, add lemon juice. Serve as a soupy main with rice.

Sesame Eromba

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	20 min	35 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Boiled vegetables pounded with roasted sesame and chilli - Manipur's mash, without fish paste.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	potatoes, boiled and peeled
150	g	french beans, boiled
40	g	white sesame seeds, roasted
3	pieces	dry red chilli, toasted
1	tsp	salt
1	tblsp	mustard oil

METHOD

1. Pound roasted sesame and chilli to a coarse paste in a stone mortar or crush in a steel bowl.
2. Mash potatoes and beans with the paste, salt and mustard oil. Keep some texture.
3. Serve at room temperature as a side to rice and stew.

Yongchak Veg (parkia)

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	15 min	25 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Stink beans with chilli. If yongchak is unavailable, use french beans.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
250	g	yongchak (parkia) or french beans, sliced
20	g	fresh ginger, julienne
3	pieces	green chilli, slit
2	tbsp	mustard oil
1	tsp	salt

METHOD

- Heat mustard oil in a steel kadhai. Add ginger and chilli.
- Add beans and salt. Stir-fry 10-12 minutes until tender with a little bite.

Boiled Seasonal Beans

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	12 min	22 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Plain boiled beans finished with ginger and chilli - a clean Manipuri side.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	seasonal beans, trimmed
15	g	fresh ginger, crushed
2	pieces	green chilli, slit
1	tsp	salt
600	ml	water

METHOD

- Boil beans in salted water with ginger and chilli for 8-10 minutes.
- Drain. Toss with a spoon of the cooking liquor. Serve hot.

Steamed Sticky Rice

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	5 min	25 min	30 min

Cookware: Stainless steel steamer and steel thali - never aluminium

The grain of the Manipuri table. Steel steamer only.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
400	g	sticky rice (glutinous rice)
800	ml	water, for soaking
1/2	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Rinse rice. Soak in water 4 hours or overnight. Drain.
2. Steam in a stainless steel steamer 20-25 minutes until translucent and sticky.
3. Fluff with a fork. Serve with chamthong or ooti. Never aluminium.

Chak-Hao Rice

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	5 min	30 min	35 min

Cookware: Stainless steel steamer and steel thali - never aluminium

Manipur black rice as the grain of the meal.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	chak-hao (Manipur black rice)
700	ml	water
1/2	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Rinse until the water runs less purple. Soak 2 hours. Drain.
2. Steam or simmer in steel with salt until grains are tender, 25-30 minutes.
3. Rest 5 minutes. The rice should be nutty and slightly chewy.

Soft Roti

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	15 min	30 min

Cookware: Cast-iron tawa (not aluminium)

Plain wheat roti for guests who want a North-Indian bread with the stew.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	whole-wheat atta
180	ml	water, or as needed
1/2	tsp	salt
1	tsp	ghee, for finishing

METHOD

- Knead atta, salt and water 5 minutes. Rest 10 minutes.
- Divide into 8 balls. Roll 15 cm discs. Cook on a cast-iron tawa until they puff.
- Brush with ghee. Keep wrapped in a cloth.

Til-Gud Ladoo

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	15 min	25 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Sesame and jaggery balls - festival sweet.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
150	g	white sesame seeds, roasted
120	g	jaggery, grated
1	tbsp	ghee
4	Pods	green cardamom, powdered

METHOD

- Melt jaggery with ghee in a steel kadhai until it forms a soft ball in cold water.
- Stir in sesame and cardamom. Off the heat, shape 12 ladoos while warm.
- Cool on a steel plate. Store in an airtight tin.

Steamed Rice Cake

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	15 min	35 min

Cookware: Stainless steel steamer and steel thali - never aluminium

Soft rice-flour cakes with jaggery and coconut.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	rice flour
100	g	jaggery, grated
80	g	fresh grated coconut
150	ml	warm water
1/4	tsp	salt
4	Pods	green cardamom, powdered

METHOD

1. Mix rice flour, jaggery, coconut, salt, cardamom and water to a thick batter.
2. Spoon into a steel idli mould or thali. Steam 12-15 minutes.
3. Unmould. Serve warm.

Coconut Ladoo

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	5 min	10 min	15 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Quick coconut balls with jaggery.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	fresh grated coconut
120	g	jaggery, grated
4	Pods	green cardamom, powdered
1	tsp	ghee, for the pan

METHOD

- Cook coconut and jaggery in a steel pan 6-8 minutes until the mix holds together.
- Add cardamom. Shape 12 ladoos. Cool.

Chak-Hao Kheer

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	45 min	55 min

Cookware: Heavy stainless steel milk pot - never aluminium

Black-rice pudding - the colour turns lilac-grey. Slow milk, steel pot only.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
80	g	chak-hao (Manipur black rice), soaked 2 hours
1	L	full-fat milk
80	g	sugar
4	Pods	green cardamom, crushed
10	g	pistachios, slivered

METHOD

1. Drain rice. Simmer in milk in a heavy steel pot, stirring often, 35-40 minutes until thick.
2. Add sugar and cardamom. Cook 5 minutes more.
3. Serve warm or chilled, topped with pistachio. Never aluminium - milk reacts.

White Rice Kheer

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	35 min	45 min

Cookware: Heavy stainless steel milk pot - never aluminium

Everyday rice kheer for the Manipuri vegetarian table.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
80	g	raw rice, rinsed
1	L	full-fat milk
80	g	sugar
4	Pods	green cardamom, crushed
15	g	raisins

METHOD

1. Simmer rice in milk in a steel pot until the grains burst and the milk is creamy, 30 minutes.
2. Add sugar, cardamom and raisins. Cook 5 minutes. Serve warm.

Yogurt with Honey

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	5 min	0 min	5 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Set yogurt with honey and sesame - no cooking pan.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
400	g	plain yogurt, chilled
3	tblsp	honey
2	tblsp	white sesame seeds, toasted

METHOD

- Spoon yogurt into 4 steel or glass bowls.
- Drizzle honey. Scatter sesame. Serve at once.

Veg Singju

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	0 min	15 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Manipuri salad with roasted sesame and besan. No nga-ri, no onion.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	cabbage, finely shredded
100	g	french beans or banana flower, thinly sliced
3	tblsp	white sesame seeds, roasted and crushed
2	tblsp	besan (gram flour), dry-roasted
2	pieces	green chilli, minced
1	tblsp	lemon juice
1	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Toss cabbage and beans with sesame, roasted besan, chilli, lemon and salt.
2. Rest 5 minutes so the besan clings. Serve the same hour - it weeps if it sits.

Cucumber Chilli Salad

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	6 min	0 min	6 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Cool cucumber with chilli and lemon. Go easy if using king chilli.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
2	pieces	cucumbers, sliced thin
1	pieces	green chilli, minced
1	tbsp	lemon juice
1/2	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Toss cucumber, chilli, lemon and salt. Serve immediately.

Cabbage Lemon Salad

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	8 min	0 min	8 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Shredded cabbage with lemon and sesame.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	cabbage, shredded
1	tbsp	lemon juice
2	tbsp	white sesame seeds, toasted
3/4	tsp	salt

METHOD

1. Toss cabbage with lemon, sesame and salt. Serve crisp and cold.